

Safety First: Stay Risk Aware in the Line of Fire

Description

In a recent incident, one of our colleagues was injured when an object was ejected from an activity with a grinder that was being carried out close to him. Although the injured person (IP) was not using the **POWERED PRODUCTION EQUIPMENT** himself, he was effected by it when a fragment caused swelling and irritation to his thigh.

Consequences

On this occasion, the fragment was a tiny piece of metal and did not cause a significant injury. The particle did need minor surgery to remove it, and the IP missed six days work awaiting treatment. Of course, had this fragment entered his eye, the injury could have been far worse

Causes of Incident

The actual cause remains unknown, but the lesson is that we are still in the line of fire if an **unexpected event** happens within the activities close to us.

Our seven point **Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)** can usually reduce the severity of injuries, but as this example shows it cannot eliminate the risk of injury from fragments or particles being ejected from high speed powered production equipment such as grinders, drills, breakers etc. or by the release of **STORED HAZARDOUS ENERGY**

When personnel are operating such equipment, the equipment will have properly fitted guards, and the operators will have specific protective equipment. If you are close to the activity, or a passer-by, you may not have been a part of the risk assessment or not been considered if the unexpected happens.

Photos



ALIGN Actions

RISK AWARENESS

- If your task means that you are close to colleagues using **POWERED PRODUCTION EQUIPMENT**, or you are exposed to **STORED HAZARDOUS ENERGY** from adjacent tasks you should consider within the **point of work risk assessment (POWRA)** to install additional guards or barriers around that activity to prevent any ejected particles from the task or to protect you should an unexpected failure occurs
- Always consider what is going on around your work area and pay attention to risks from activities close to you within your **POWRA**
- If the risk changes when a new activity starts nearby you and feel that you are in the line of fire, raise a **SLAM**.
- Move clear and stay clear, escalate your concerns and don't move back until improvements are put in place or the activity stops.
- If your planned role means being close to activities with powered production equipment, you should wear the same PPE as the operator. Make sure to raise this at your **POWRA** if has not been considered and request any additional PPE.
- Always wear the required **7-Point PPE** in all work areas as this can reduce risk of severe injury should the unexpected occur and you are in the **LINE OF FIRE**